

Congo

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 20, 1959 **Usage:** National and Civil

The Pan-African colors of red, yellow, and green



The distinctive diagonal pattern sets it apart from other Pan-African flags

Africa



Congo was a French colony until independence as Congo-Brazzaville in 1960. After a coup in 1964, it became the People's Republic (1970–91).

The current flag was originally adopted for the autonomous republic, established on August 18, 1959. It is in the pan-African colors used by many other West African flags. It was retained without change when full independence was achieved in 1960.

THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC 1970–91

Following the Marxist revolution in 1964, no new national flag was officially adopted until the People's Republic was formed in 1970. This flag was red and contained the national emblem in the canton. The emblem depicted a wreath containing a crossed hoe and hammer, and a gold star. This represented the communist

regime which had taken power.

AN OLD FLAG FOR A NEW ERA

At the National Conference for the restoration of democracy in 1991, which restored a multiparty democracy, it was decided to re-adopt the original flag, arms and national anthem. This decision was made official on June 4, 1991.

ARMS OF CONGO

The coat of arms was originally adopted in 1963 and was designed by the European heraldist Louis Mühlemann, who also designed the arms of Gabon. It follows a traditional European heraldic style.